Ricard Gascons

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Software engineer with 9 years of experience, now specializing in natural language to SQL (NL2SQL) and LLM post-training. EU citizen, relocating to Barcelona.

Microsoft Redmond, Washington — Jun. 2024 - Present

Senior Software Engineer, LLM Post-Training — Aug. 2026 - Present

- Build pipelines that generate synthetic question and answer pairs from semantic models to fine-tune models (SFT), raising benchmark scores on question-answer pairs from 60% to 74%
- Build and run benchmarks that test how well models answer business questions over structured data (NL2SQL), including on semantic models the model has not seen
- Use benchmark results to find failure patterns and decide what training data to generate next

Senior Software Engineer, Copilot for Power BI — Dec. 2024 - Jul. 2026

- Built evals for the Copilot Summary feature and led its model upgrade from GPT 4 to GPT 5, raising coverage from 72% to 80% and improving regression by 4-5%, with no drop in relevance
- Led a team of 4 on an unannounced Copilot feature, a key requirement before large organizations can adopt Copilot at scale. Owned the technical design end to end, from ideation with PMs to tech spec review with Power BI architects
- Worked on Copilot infrastructure (2M monthly active users) across the stack (C#, TypeScript, SQL)

Senior Software Engineer, Metric Sets — Jun. 2024 - Nov. 2024

- Squad Lead: led a team of 4 to build Metric Sets, helping organizations define, discover, and reuse trusted metrics (1000 MAU). Designed its core capabilities: Git Integration, Desktop support, and Copilot support.

Uber Seattle, Washington — Sep. 2022 - May 2024

Software Engineer II

- Led a team of 3 to build a company-wide website to track and edit Incentives for Uber Drivers globally, cutting the time to edit one Incentive from 30+ minutes to seconds
- Led the development and architecture of *Unified UI*, a composable UI framework that increased development velocity by >300%. Over 20 Uber apps use it, and multiple teams contribute to it
- Migrated Unified UI from *FlowJS* to *TypeScript*, lowering build times by 50% and raising developer velocity from 4 to 6 PRs a week

Microsoft Redmond, Washington — Sep. 2017 - Aug. 2022

Software Engineer II

- Built *React* user flows to increase enterprise engagement with Office 365, which raised subscriptions by 5%, added $750k in monthly revenue, and improved reliability from 99.8% to 99.93%
- Added international payment options (AliPay, SEPA) in *ASP.NET*, raising monthly subscriptions by 5%
- Expanded the Office Translator in *React* for Word, PowerPoint, Excel, and OneNote (4 million daily users), improving customer satisfaction by 15%
- Built an automated *SQL* workflow for daily product metrics, improving data pipeline SLAs by 10%

Education

UPC BarcelonaTech, Barcelona — 2013 - 2017

B.S. in Computer Science

Skills

- ML: LLM post-training (SFT), NL2SQL, synthetic data generation, benchmark and eval design
- Comfortable: Python, TypeScript, React, C#, ASP.NET, SQL. Familiar: Go, Java, C++